reduced blood flow (atherosclerosis) or other artery conditions.

- **An Embolic Stroke:** Occurs when a blood clot or other debris forms away from the brain commonly in the heart and is swept through bloodstream to lodge in narrower brain arteries. This type of blood clot is called an embolus.

Haemorrhagic stroke

Haemorrhagic stroke occurs when a blood vessel in the brain leaks or ruptures. Brain haemorrhages can result from many conditions that affect the blood vessels. These include:

- Uncontrolled high blood pressure (hypertension)
- Over treatment with anticoagulants (blood thinners)
- Weak spots in the blood vessel walls (aneurysms)

Types of haemorrhagic stroke include

- **Intracerebral hemorrhage.** In an intracerebral hemorrhage, a blood vessel in the brain bursts and spills into the surrounding brain tissue, damaging brain cells.
- **Subarachnoid hemorrhage.** In a subarachnoid hemorrhage, an artery on or near the surface of the brain bursts and spills into the space between the surface of your brain and the skull. This bleeding is often signaled by a sudden, severe headache.

Transient ischemic attack (TIA)

A transient ischemic attack (TIA) - sometimes known as a ministroke - is a temporary period of symptoms similar to stroke.

Risk Factors

Lifestyle risk factors : Being overweight or obese, Physical inactivity, Alcohol consumption, Use of illicit drugs such as cocaine and methamphetamines

Medical risk factors: Blood pressure readings higher than 140/90 millimeters of mercury, Cigarette smoking or exposure to secondhand smoke, High cholesterol, Diabetes, Obstructive sleep apnea, Cardiovascular disease, including heart failure, heart defects, heart infection or abnormal heart rhythm, Personal or family history of stroke, heart attack or transient ischemic attack.

Other factors associated with a higher risk of stroke include

- Age - People age 55 or older, race, sex, men have a higher risk of stroke than women, Hormones- use of birth control pills or hormone therapies that include estrogen, as well as increased estrogen levels from pregnancy and childbirth.

Signs and Symptoms:

- Sudden weakness, paralysis or numbness of the face, arm or leg especially on one side of the body.
- Sudden dimness or loss of vision in one or both eyes.
- Sudden loss of speech, confusion, or difficulty speaking or understanding speech.
- Unexplained sudden dizziness, unsteadiness, loss of balance or coordination.
- Sudden severe headache.

Diagnosis

- **Blood tests:** blood sugar levels, platelet levels, Bleeding time and clotting time
- Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) scan
- Computerized Tomography (CT) scan.

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